



Many of Zeus's immortal children had unusual birth stories. One day Zeus had a bad headache.

He asked his son Hephaestus [hef-EEST-us] to split open his head with an axe. Out sprang Athena [a-THEE-na], dressed for battle and shouting her war cry.

Just like us, these titanic Olympians had emotions such as love, jealousy and anger. They were fascinated by people and meddled in their lives with both heroic and fateful consequences. ❖

Athena's city

Athens, the capital of Greece, was named for Athena after she won a competition against Poseidon.

